

YEAR 10 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 2 · CLASSICS

# Reading

B1+/B2

A Life Behind the Camera · What Makes a Story a Classic?

Hazırlık Sonrası 10. Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

**Aim** Understand the main idea and details, make inferences and connect the text to your own life.

## 1 Before you read

*Make predictions before you read.*

1. Look at the title. What kind of person do you think this text is about?  
\_\_\_\_\_
2. Do you know any directors or authors who became famous later in life? What was their early life like?  
\_\_\_\_\_

## A Life Behind the Camera

- 1 Long before he became known for his dreamlike animated worlds, the director grew up in a quiet town far from any film studio. As a boy, he used to spend hours drawing his own comic strips instead of doing his homework, and his teachers often complained that he never paid attention in class. Nobody in his family had worked in film before, so when he announced that he wanted to make movies, his parents were quietly worried.
- 2 His first years in the industry were far from glamorous. While he was working as a junior animator, he spent long nights redrawing scenes that senior directors rejected, and he nearly gave up more than once. Everything changed when he was finally allowed to direct a short film of his own. It told a simple story about a lonely girl and a magical forest, but audiences who saw it were deeply moved, and critics praised its gentle, thoughtful pace.
- 3 Decades later, his films are studied in universities and loved by children and adults alike. He still insists that every frame should be drawn by hand whenever possible, even in an age of computer animation. When a journalist once asked why he never used more modern techniques, he simply replied that a story feels more honest when you can see the artist's hand behind it.

221 words

**2 While you read**

5 × 2 pts

*Circle the correct option.*

- What did the director use to do as a boy, according to the text?  
☐ a He worked in a film studio.    ☐ b He drew his own comic strips instead of doing homework.  
☐ c He wrote novels with his grandmother.
- As a junior animator, he spent long nights \_\_\_\_\_ scenes that senior directors rejected.
- What was his first short film about?  
☐ a A lonely girl and a magical forest    ☐ b A director's difficult childhood    ☐ c A famous novelist's life
- According to the text, the director's family were experienced filmmakers who supported him immediately.    ☐ Correct    ☐ Incorrect

- He believes a story feels more honest when you can see the \_\_\_\_\_ behind it.

**3 After you read***Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.*

- Why do you think the director still prefers hand-drawn animation, even today?  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Would you rather watch a hand-drawn film or a computer-animated one? Why?  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

**1 Before you read***Make predictions before you read.*

- Before you read, think of a book or film you consider a 'classic'. Why do you think it has lasted so long?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- What do you think makes a fictional character memorable?  
\_\_\_\_\_

**What Makes a Story a Classic?**

- Every year, thousands of new novels and films are released, yet only a small number are still discussed decades later. So what separates a passing bestseller from a genuine classic? One answer lies in the characters themselves. A classic protagonist usually has flaws as well as strengths, which makes them feel believable rather than perfect. Readers remember characters who make difficult choices, not ones who always know exactly what to do.

- 2 Setting plays an important role too. Many classic stories are set in a specific time and place, yet they explore ideas that go far beyond that setting — loyalty, ambition, loss, forgiveness. A short story about a fisherman on a remote island can still say something true about any reader's own life, wherever and whenever they happen to be reading it.
- 3 Finally, a classic often rewards a second reading or a second viewing. On the first read, we usually focus on the plot: what happens next? On the second, we start to notice smaller details — a narrator who isn't entirely honest, an antagonist who has understandable reasons for their actions, a piece of dialogue that means something different once we know how the story ends. It's this depth, more than fame or sales figures, that keeps a story alive.

211 words

## 2 While you read

5 × 2 pts

Circle the correct option.

- According to the text, what usually makes a classic protagonist feel believable?
 

☐ a Being perfect and never making mistakes    ☐ b Having both flaws and strengths  
☐ c Always knowing exactly what to do
- The text says setting matters, but classic stories explore ideas that go far beyond that \_\_\_\_\_.
- According to the text, a classic story usually only rewards one reading or viewing. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- What might a reader notice on a second reading, according to the text?
 

☐ a A completely different plot    ☐ b Small details, such as an unreliable narrator  
☐ c The exact sales figures of the book
- The text concludes that it is depth, more than fame or \_\_\_\_\_, that keeps a story alive.

## 3 After you read

Write short answers. Then compare with a partner.

- Do you agree that a story needs 'depth' to become a classic? Can you think of a counter-example?
 

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- Think of a story you've read or watched more than once. Did you notice something new the second time?
 

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